in the morning to this). This is because the actual area in contact when you place your hand on a surface, or your back on the bed, is a miniscule fraction of the area that can be in contact, sometimes less than even 10 per cent. You may have the largest hands in the world, but your hands are made up of many ridges and valleys, especially at a microscopic level, the same goes for the surface you are in contact with. Due to this, even though your hand seems to be in contact with the glass window, it's actually floating on a bed of "pins and needles". The gecko ensures better area of contact as it has hairy toes, and not just any hairy toes. Each foot can have up to half a million hair on them. The ends of these hair are also split. What does all this add up to? A foot that's capable of holding up more than 500 times the gecko's weight. Now you may be wondering why a gecko doesn't just get stuck to the floor or wall the moment it's born. I mean, if its feet really are that sticky, won't it be impossible to pry them off? This doesn't happen because the "adhesive" is a directional one. There are only sticky when force is applied in one direction, allowing a gecko to "peel off" from the floor and proceed without ripping its feet off. There's a method to this, which even an agent of Ethan Hunt's caliber had to be explained when using the gloves.

Maybe someday we'll be able to lick our own eyes like this inspiring creature

The gloves are based on the same principle. They consist of rubber or plastic (or any material in fact) covered with a mass of hard-plastic microfibres which mimic the surface of a gecko's foot. This material is very sticky and has the same directional adhesive property. But, to support a man weighing in at 70 kg, you would need an area of contact amounting to a 10x10cm patch. There's obviously a lot of room for improvement, especially if you consider that nature's design ensures that 20 square cm can hold 130 kg. All this without the need for fancy lighting and the weird electronic hum.

Augmented reality is fine, but you don't want this while driving

We say

The technology exists, but is still a few years away from making human spiders a reality. *MI IV* did use existing technology but the reason for the lights and hum is beyond us. Especially the reason why one of the gloves failed when it's a simple matter of surface contact. Maybe the IMF rigged up some sort of electrostatic charge inducer or something to improve the efficiency of the glove. Who knows? Anything is possible.

Smart car fine, but a smarter man?

Who can forget Ethan Hunt's futuristic Beemer? A garish supercar with flashing lights and transparent panels. Is that really what an undercover spy needs on his sojourn to a foreign land? That too in a country known for its speedbreakers and potholes. We think this agent didn't do his research properly. It's possible that it was a stroke of brilliance on the agent's part, as Sherlock Holmes once said, "It's so ostentatious that it's surreptitious". Maybe we're doing the agent an injustice.

The car in question actually exists and even more importantly, BMW actually plan to put it into production. You can read more about it at http://bit.ly/zopzSM. The car doesn't come with the fancy radar and smart display and most probably the fancy design will be replaced with a more sedate one for now. It's a very interesting car however, having both, a fuel-cell powered electric motor as well as an IC engine. The smart window seemed to work quite well in the movie but practically it seems to have too many flaws. The fact that a map shows up on the screen is interesting and so is the fact that people and obstacles